A-A-53238
29 September 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a sterilization envelope suitable for holding surgical instruments during ethylene oxide sterilization or autoclaving procedures, and for maintaining sterility afterwards.

Salient characteristics:

The sterilization envelope shall have a paper back and transparent plastic front suitable for holding surgical instruments during ethylene oxide sterilization or autoclaving procedures and maintaining sterility afterwards. The envelope shall be approximately 10 inches long by 5-1/4 inches wide (25.4 cm by 13.3 cm).

The envelope shall be the open-end type with the opening at one end only. It shall be capable of being peeled open from the seal closure end.

The envelope shall be a self-sealing type. The adhesive material shall be applied to the open-end flap and the backside of the body of the cover in strips so that when the open-end flap is closed, both adhesive strips shall join and permanently seal the contents. A spot or dab of adhesive material at these points shall not be acceptable.

The adhesive material shall be self-sealing gumming which shall have a shelf life of not less than 36 months. The adhesive material shall withstand steam and ethylene oxide sterilization of not less than 250°F and a steam pressure of 15 pounds per square inch, for a minimum of 30 minutes per sterilization.

The envelope shall be permeable enough to permit entrance of live steam and ethylene oxide for sterilization, and sufficiently impermeable after sterilization so that contamination from the air shall not enter into the cover.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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The envelope shall be marked with a time-temperature-steam and ethylene oxide sensitive ink that will turn color, thereby providing a visual indicator to show that the contents have been subjected to conditions of sterilization.

The envelope shall have printing which shall consist of four horizontal lines placed approximately 1/2 inch (1.3 cm) apart, headed by legends for sterilization and expiration dates, sterilizer and load numbers, and the contents.

Both surfaces of the sterilization envelope shall be strong enough to minimize perforations. The plastic surface shall be clear enough for easy product identification.

The envelope shall be free of tears, cuts, holes, perforations, grease, dirt, or foreign matter.

Workmanship. The sterilization envelope shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing four hundred sterilization envelopes, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table I. The unit of product for sampling purposes shall be three sterilization envelopes as specified in this description.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

	Inspection level	AQL (defects per hundred units)
For visual examination		
Major defects	II	1.0
Total defects (Major and minor combined)	II	4.0
For dimensional examination	S-1	2.5

Examination. The sterilization envelope shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the classification of defects listed in table II. Examination shall not be restricted to the classified possible defects below.

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TABLE II. Classification of Defects.

Classification	Defects
Major	
101	Envelope has more than one opening.
102	Envelope has insufficient adhesive material applied to the open-end flap.
103	Envelope not marked with a time-temperature-steam and ethylene oxide sensitive ink.
104	Envelope does not have the required printing.
105	Envelope not free of tears, cuts, holes or perforations.
Minor	
201	Plastic front not clear enough for easy product identification.
202	Envelope not free of grease, dirt, or foreign material.

Dimensional Examination. The sterilization envelope shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the specifications herein shall be classified as a defect.

Tests.

Envelope adhesive test.

The open-end flap of the envelope shall be closed and permanently sealed. The envelope shall then be subjected to steam sterilization of not less than 250°F and a steam pressure of 15 pounds per square inch, for a minimum of 30 minutes. After sterilization is complete, the envelope seal shall be inspected. Failure of the adhesive seal shall be cause for rejection.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-01-151-1807

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

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A-A-53238

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-1955

PGC 59516

Location: CID/ENVELOPE/H13-5

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions - Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53238	Envelope, Sterilization

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (Mark one)
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER (Specify) _____
b. ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code)	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording.

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER (Last, First, MI) – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code) – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION (YYMMDD)

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